

works are *Blond Eckbert* (1994), an operatic reworking of a German folk tale about obsessive fear; her *Piano Concerto* (1997) for piano and strings; *The Welcome Arrival of Rain* (2001), for orchestra; and her opera *Miss Fortune* (2012).

The qualities Weir most admires in works of literature are, she says, “concision, clarity, lightness, and (hidden) wisdom”—qualities that are evident in many of her own musical creations. She is also a composer of great imaginative power, a tremendous storyteller with immense breadth of vision, whose work is lively, richly expressive, complex, and often understated and ironic. Her contribution to the field has been recognized in a string of impressive awards and appointments, including posts at Cardiff, Glasgow, Princeton, and Harvard universities, a CBE (1995), the Queen’s Medal for Music (2007), and the first female Master of the Queen’s Music (2014).